Order No. 960-98-98

January 28, 2023

# Editor's Report

Thank you for the opportunity to edit your paper on candidates' physical appearance and effects on voters and election outcomes. As an American voter, I found your extremely knowledgeable analysis very interesting. It had some challenges lying not in how you treat the subject but in some issues with language, the focus of most of my editing.

Let me hasten to assure you that I have cut and pasted the newly edited sections you identified to replace those sections marked in blue font in your memo. Seeing no other instructions about editing the memo, I did not touch it beyond carrying out your explicit instructions, particularly in light of the need for authors to communicate with reviewers without any third-party influence. In short, without instructions to edit the memo, I did not, hoping not to create extra work for you by doing things you did not want me to do.

In addition to such issues as vocabulary, correct phrasing, and eliminating redundancies, I have edited for correct grammar, the flow of the work, and academic tone. As requested, I have edited for compliance with U.S. English spelling and punctuation. The technical terminology is edited only to offer insights into the reader's point of view and suggestions for increasing clarity and accessibility. I included your citations in my proofreading only to the extent of noting any in-text inconsistencies or issues that you will want to check; they are flagged in the citations or in References, wherever a problem materialized requiring your intervention. Similarly, matters related to a sanctioned style, instructions to authors, or other protocols for the mechanics of the paper were also beyond my purview, particularly since that is now in the hands of you and your reviewers and editors. Nonetheless, anything I saw that I thought might need your attention has a note for you to consider.

I also must clearly say that although I frequently edit papers that devote detailed sections to research results, data analysis, and proofs of hypotheses, I make no claim to anything approaching expertise with statistical analysis. Please do not assume that having proofread it, I offer any opinion at all on the quality of that analysis or the conclusions you draw from it—I do not because I cannot. Clearly, your reviewers are the other "set of eyes" with the ability to look that over and give you any assurance or guidance on that score.

I have provided two versions of the paper and the memo, respectively—one showing all edits and margin notes, the other a "clean" copy with the edits incorporated into your text and the comments deleted. Please review all edits and notes carefully before accepting or rejecting them. I wish you the best with finalizing and submitting your paper.

Sincerely,

Amy R., Ph.D.